World Sailing | eSailing World Championship | Virtual Regatta

2026 eSailing World Championship Knockout 4 Sailing Instruction

sport / nature / technology

Event websites: https://www.sailing.org/our-sport/esailing/ and www.virtualregatta.com

Notation	Meaning
[NP]	The notation '[NP]' in a rule means that a player may not protest another player for breaking that rule. The PRO and/or the protest committee and/or the OA may refuse to hold a hearing when a player protests, based on these rules. This changes RRS 60.1.
[SP]	The notation '[SP]' in a rule means that a player may be disqualified by the race committee from the event without a hearing according to RRS 60.5(b)(3). This changes RRS A5.1.
[VRI]	Virtual Regatta Inshore, the eSailing platform licensed to host the eSailing World Championships.
[WS]	World Sailing, International Federation for Sailing and eSailing World Championships rights holder.
[VR]	Virtual Regatta, the organisation that provides the eSailing platform: Virtual Regatta Inshore.
[OA]	The organising authority: World Sailing.
[TC]	The technical committee: World Sailing and Virtual Regatta technical departments.
[RC]	The race committee
[PC]	The protest committee

Terminology.

The RRS Terminology paragraph of the Introduction is changed so that:

Boat: means a sailboat controlled remotely and having no crew. However, in the rules of Part 1 and Part 5, this SI and the definitions Party and Protest, 'boat' includes the competitor controlling her.

1. Registration and Arena Joining Instructions

1.1. [NP] Registration

1.1.1. **[SP]** 40 Players qualified and Players from 41st position to 120th position on the waiting list shall request the 'KO 4 Qualified' Role by typing their VRI name in the '📝ko4-registration' Discord channel and filling the form sent via email. The form will also be accessible via the discord channel '📝ko4-registration'. Roles will be assigned as soon as reasonably possible.

1.1.2. Players have until 23/1/2026 13:00 UTC to request the role and fill the form. Players are registered once the role is given.

1.1.3. **[SP]** Requesting the role and filling the form confirms that the player will attend the knockout, including the ones in the waiting list if

called upon. Players not attending the knockout should not request the role.

1.1.4. **[SP]** Players qualified and on the waiting list not attending the Knockout 4 should contact the OA by using the same channel described in SI 1.1.1. Players registering and not showing up without communicating the withdrawal to the OA, at least by 24/01/2026 13:00 UTC may be forbidden to participate in future WS Events. Spots will be offered first to the top 40 players who have registered and are not yet qualified for the Semi-Final and Playoffs. Any remaining spots will then be allocated to registered players on the Waiting List, following the ranking of Qualifier 4.
The same applies in case of any player's withdrawals within the time limit of SI 1.1.4.

1.1.5. Players qualified and on the waiting list are required to join the World Sailing Tournaments Discord Server and the eSWC respective categories and channels according to NOR 10, and change their server's name to their VRI in-game name. They can do so by typing "/nick", in any channel they have access to and entering their Virtual Regatta Inshore, In-game name.

1.1.6. **[NP]**The organising authority reserves the right to accept late entries and late withdrawals.

1.1.7. **[SP]** Players shall not change their VRI in-game name during the event.

1.1.8. **[NP]** If as a result of a protest committee decision published after registration has started, a player would enter the top 40, then there may be more than 40 Players in the qualifying series.

1.2. [NP] Arena Joining Instructions

1.2.1. Players will compete in one single fleet. The fleet will have separate password protected arenas to race and will be available to enter via the 'eSWC' blue lobby zone.

1.2.2. Passwords for the arenas will be shared via a private Discord channel for each stage, to which qualified players will be invited.

1.2.3. The time for the starting sequence of each race will be posted on the Discord channel of each series/stage. This time will be posted in 24-hour format, UTC time zone (i.e. 17:18 UTC), and will be no less than 3 minutes from the time it was posted.

1.2.4. **[NP]** Players may flag any joining issues in the respective group chat '💬-ko4-global-chat' channel on the WS Discord Server within the 'Knockout 4' Server Category by tagging '@RaceOfficer' and hailing 'Join issue'. The race will be postponed for 3 minutes to wait for players to join. After this time, the starting sequence will begin and a player's failure to join the arena will not be grounds for request for redress. This changes RRS 61.2.

2. Schedule

2.1. The first warning signal for Race 1 will be at 13:00 UTC on 25/01/2026. The following races will take place as soon as reasonably possible following the

end of the race prior. The Medal series will take place as soon as possible after the qualifying series and after all protests, if any, have been closed.

2.2. Schedule of races

Series	**Race**	**Classes**	**Course**	**Wind**
Qualifying	1	Nacra 17	LAR2 Very Long	21
Qualifying	2	Ilca	LAR2 Medium	18
Qualifying	3	49er	LAR2 Very Long	22
Qualifying	4	FarEast28	LAR2 Long	20
Qualifying	5	Offshore	LAR2 Long	17
Qualifying	6	F18	LAR2 Long	22
Medal	Semifinal	Star	LAR2 Short	18
Medal	Final	J70	LAR2 Short	19

2.3. No Qualifying series races warning signal will be made later than 2 hours after the scheduled time for the first warning signal of the event.

2.4. No Medal Series races warning signal will be made later than 3 hours after the scheduled time for the first warning signal of the event.

2.5. In the event of any delay caused by the system, the OA reserves the right to extend the cut-off times according to SIs 2.3 and 2.4 to the approximate length of the delay; such extension will be determined at the OA's sole discretion, and subject at all times to 1 hour maximum. In case of longer delays, the OA may reschedule the remaining races for a later date.

2.6. The venue will be a virtual render of Sydney.

3. Format

3.1. The event will be split into two stages.

3.2. Qualifying Series

3.2.1. Stage 1 will be a 'Qualifying Series' with a single fleet of 40 Players.

3.2.2. Players will race a maximum of 6 races back to back.

3.2.3. **Advancement.** The **top 6** players advance to the Medal Series.

3.3. Medal Series

3.3.1. Stage 2 will be the 'Medal Series'.

3.3.2. Stage 2 will consist of two races: Semifinal and Final.

3.3.3. The top 4 players ranked in the Semifinal will qualify to the Final.

4. Courses

4.1. Courses are as described in **Annex A.**

4.2. All course marks will be yellow.

4.3. The starting line will be the red line drawn between a race committee vessel and a yellow mark.

5. Time limits

5.1. **[NP]** Players who do not start within 60 seconds after their starting signal will be scored Did Not Start without a hearing. This changes RRS A5.1.

5.2. **[NP]** Players who do not finish within 600 seconds after the finishing time of the player in first position will be scored Did Not Finish without a hearing. This changes RRS A5.1.

6. Scoring

6.1. One race is required to constitute a series.

6.2. No discards will be applied.

6.3. According to RRS 90.3, Scoring will be a low scoring point system, with the following changes:

6.3.1. The Qualifying series score will be the total of the races of the entire series.

6.3.2. For the Medal Series, players will carry scores in the following way:

6.3.2.1. Qualifying series player in first place will be scored 1 point.

6.3.2.2. Qualifying series player in second place will be scored 2 points.

6.3.2.3. Qualifying series players in third to sixth places will be scored 3 points.

6.3.3. Medal Series:

6.3.3.1. The semifinal has no changes in scoring. The tiebreaker for the Semifinal is the Qualifying series position.This changes RRS A7 and A8.

6.3.3.2. In case the Final is not sailed, Players qualified to the Final will be ranked before the other Players.

6.3.3.3. Final race will assign points as following:

6.3.3.3.1. First place will receive 1 point.

6.3.3.3.2. Second place will receive 6 points.

6.3.3.3.3. Third and fourth places will receive 7 points.

6.3.3.3.4. The tiebreaker for the final will be the position in the Final race. This changes RRS A8.

6.4. Scoring inquiries shall be presented to the Race Officer using the same method to file a protest or request for redress. Parties shall use the Discord Channel created for the request to provide or request additional information.

6.5. **[NP]** Results will be posted in the '💯-ko4-scores' Discord channel as soon as possible after each race is completed. Results obtained from the VRI Engine will be final.

7. Changes to Sailing Instructions

7.1. **[NP]** Amendments to official documents will be posted on the Official Notice Board on the WS Discord Server in the '📜-ko4-notice-board' channel no later than 15 minutes before the scheduled time for the first warning signal of the event, unless there is a change to the schedule, which will be posted no later than 24 hours prior.

8. Starting Sequence

8.1. Upon completion of the time frames stated in SI 1.2, the first warning signal will be made with a sound and visual signal denoting 80 seconds until the start. This changes VRRS 26.1.

8.2. **[NP]** A second sound and visual signal denotes 60 seconds until the start. The in-game rule engine activates at this point and penalties are active.

8.3. **[NP]** The third sound and visual signal denotes the race start. Players may cross the start line and begin the race.

9. Hearing requests

9.1. The protest time limit for incidents observed in the racing area is 2 minutes after the results screenshots are posted in the designated Discord channel. Other protests shall be delivered as soon as reasonably possible after the relevant information is available to the protestor. The protest committee shall extend the time if there is good reason to do so. This changes RRS 60.3(b).

9.2. A request for redress shall be delivered as soon as reasonably possible after the relevant information is available. The protest committee shall extend the time if there is good reason to do so. This changes RRS 61.2(b).

9.3. A request to reopen shall be delivered within 3 minutes after being informed of the decision. This changes RRS 63.7.

9.4. Process for filing a protest:

9.4.1. Open the World Sailing Tournaments Discord server https://discord.gg/FTMCzrxjkE.

9.4.2. Find the '🪧Protest' section.

9.4.3. Head over to the '🙋-hail' channel.

9.4.4. Click on the '📩 File a Protest' button.

9.4.5. Enter each section accurately.

9.4.6. A new Discord channel with the number of the protest will appear and will be used as the official means of communication for that protest. This channel will be used to present the relevant evidence for the protest.

9.4.7. The protest committee will receive the protest and will provide a reply within five minutes through the protest specific channel to confirm that the protest was received correctly or to ask players to provide additional information.

9.5. Protests or requests for redress without recordings or clear visual proof will not be considered valid. Players will have 3 minutes after delivering the protest to provide the evidence. The protest committee shall extend the time if there is a good reason to do so. This changes RRS 60.4.

9.6. RRS 60.5(a) is changed to: "The protest committee may decide a protest without a hearing after gathering evidence from parties and witnesses as appropriate. When doing so, the protest committee shall comply with rules 63.5 and 63.6. When the protest committee cannot find facts, it shall conduct a hearing as required by rule 63 to decide the protest."

9.7. RRS 61.4(a) is changed to: "The protest committee may decide a request for redress without a hearing after gathering evidence from parties and witnesses as appropriate. When doing so, the protest committee shall

comply with rules 63.5 and 63.6. When the protest committee cannot find facts, it shall conduct a hearing as required by rule 63 to decide whether to grant redress."

9.8. RRS 61.4(b) is changed to: "A boat is entitled to redress if her score or place in a race or series has been made, or may be made, significantly worse through no fault of her own by

(1) an improper action or improper omission of a committee, the organisation providing the eSailing platform or the organising authority, but not by a protest committee decision when the boat was a party to the hearing,

(2) Deleted.

(3) Deleted.

(4) giving help (except to herself or her crew) in compliance with rule 1.1, or

(5) an action of another boat, or a crew member or support person of that boat, that resulted in a penalty under rule 2 or a penalty or warning under rule 69.

However, network errors, lag, inability to connect, or any other analogous events on the boat's side are not actions or omissions of the organisation providing the eSailing platform.

9.9. All hearings will take place virtually on the WS Discord Server at the time published by the Protest Committee, according to the following:

9.9.1. All protests and requests for redress hearings from the Qualifying series will take place after the last race of the Qualifying Series.

9.9.2. All protests and requests for redress hearings from the Gold Series will take place after the Gold Series.

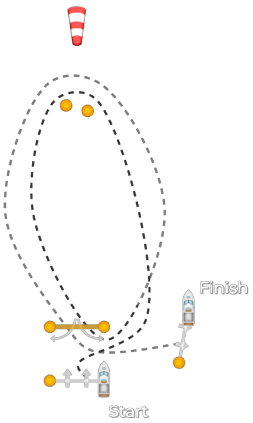
9.10. All hearings will take place in the 'Protest Room' voice channel. Upon submitting a protest in accordance with SI 9.3, a 'Waiting Room' voice channel will be made available. Parties will be called into the 'Protest Room' voice channel from the 'Waiting Room':
https://discord.com/channels/759749563316699146/1204835416004493392

9.11. A player's failure to join the 'Waiting Room' 3 mins after a member of the protest committee, the organizing authority, VIrtual Regatta or the race committee posted a notification to do so in the protest thread or the '👂-ko4-hearing-calls' Discord channel will not be ground for being unavoidably absent from the hearing. This changes RRS 63.7(a)(1).

9.12. Protest committee decisions may be communicated verbally. This changes RRS 63.6.

Annex A

A.1 Course diagram for LAR 2 Short Medium and Long



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